Don’t Restrict Access Inside the Company, but Keep it Internal

Sometimes people like to hide data to protect themselves or others. This is usually a bad idea within your own company or across your own team. If data is used in a collaborative and open way across your company, then you should allow anyone to access the data. If you work in an environment where culture encourages the use of data in a negative way (for political gain, for example), then it may be best to just keep the data accessible inside your team to avoid distraction from outside.

On the flip side, dashboards contain a lot of information about how you work and in some cases what you’re working on. It’s always best to think about keeping your websites and data as secure as possible at all times. Even though you should keep it open inside the office, you should keep it from prying eyes outside your walls.

Make it customizable

Managers, developers, executives, and coaches will all want to see data differently. You should give them the flexibility to see metrics the way they want and when they want. If you’re using the tools we’ve been using throughout this book, you can use Kibana’s great UI to create your own dashboard and save it. An example of the elements used to save dashboards and update widgets is shown in figure 9.15.

Figure 9.15. The Kibana header and some of its customizable elements

